

Homage to the Three Jewels (Prostration Ritual before a Representation of the Three Jewels)

Toh 779 · Derge Kangyur

དཀའ་ཁྲི་མཆོག་གསུམ་ལ་ཕགྱ་འཆོལ་ལ།

This short text, found as Toh 779 in the Kangyur, is a mantra-based practice instruction whose title in English may be rendered along the lines of a rite for prostrating to the Three Jewels; its Sanskrit and Tibetan titles cannot be confidently determined from the opening alone. It begins with homage to the Three Jewels (the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha) and prescribes reciting a mantra once before a representation of them while performing a full-length prostration. The text promises that three such prostrations equal the merit of hearing, reflecting upon, and meditating on the three collections of the teachings, the Tripiṭaka. It further states that three prostrations made daily will lead, in this very lifetime, to the meditative absorption of the wisdom of the path of seeing, and that until then one will be protected from harm by humans, nonhumans, and spirits. As Toh 779 in the Kangyur, it belongs to the tantra section, among the brief ritual and dhāraṇī-style texts that pair a mantra with a devotional practice and a promise of its benefits.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Before a representation of the Three Jewels, recite this mantra once and make one prostration with the body fully stretched out. If three prostrations are made, one becomes equal in merit to having heard, reflected upon, and meditated upon the three collections of the teachings (the Tripiṭaka).

If three prostrations are made each day, then in this very lifetime one will attain the meditative absorption of the wisdom of the path of seeing. And until that is attained, one will not be harmed by humans, by nonhumans, by spirits, and by

Translator's Notes

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence, ending on a list of beings, so the translation ends there as well. The opening syllable "so" and the following lines are scribal or colophon-like markers and are not translated. The mantra itself is not included in the passage. "Stretched out" renders a term for a full-length prostration, with the body extended; this is the likely sense but not certain. "Meditative absorption of the wisdom of the path of seeing" follows the house glossary, and the claim of such an attainment in this life reflects the typical promissory style of benefit-statements attached to devotional practices.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.